

ENG101 LESSON 23

Practice 1:

The following sentences can be improved by using the correct connectives and making the subordinate thoughts give emphasis to the main thought.

1. *I was reaching down to pick up my cap just as I saw the two snakes.*
2. *We came within sight of the village when our car suddenly caught fire.*
3. *Because he has been to college is no sign he is cultured.*
4. *The main reason I left early was because I was bored.*
5. *Mr. Jamshed is the Vice President while the Saeed is the Secretary.*

Practice 2:

The following sentences are lacking in unity. Improve them by adding details & changing words where necessary.

1. *The librarian was so discouraged about the lack of funds.*
2. *Our situation is too wonderful*
3. *Trying to work when my neighbour is playing his drum is such a problem.*
4. *The young ladies wore bright coloured socks and were kind hearted*
5. *She is so talented.*
6. *Computer courses have more appeal for the college student today.*

The following sentences are examples of faulty constructions.

- (a) *She told me to look on the table and that I should tell her what I found.*
- (b) *Seema's job is reading books and to write book reviews.*
- (c) *He was considerate, friendly, and people respected him.*
- (d) *The couple want to travel extensively and new experiences.*

(e) *The professor drew attention to the beginning of the revolution and how it ended.*

(f) *Getting the groceries, taking the children to school and to feed the dog are his daily tasks.* NOTE 1: e.g. *For lunch I had an apple pie and banana.*

Correlatives 2. *He not only likes tennis but also golf.*

Practice 3:

The following sentences contain errors in parallelism.

Correct the errors.

1. *Swimming and to go fishing are my favourite sports*

2. *I both want exercise and to be amused.*

3. *He offered either to pay for it now or tomorrow.*

4. *Not only were they disappointed but also angry.*

5. *As we were unfamiliar with the route and because of approaching darkness, we decided to ask for advice.*

6. *The boy's face was streaked with dirt and his feet muddy.*

1. Reference of Pronouns: e.g.

(i) *Ahmed saw Basit and Zahid yesterday and he said that he had the money.* (ambig)

(ii) *My aunt's cat was crippled; and she was never the same again.* (ambiguous aunt, cat?)

(iii) *She put the computer on the table, which her sister had bought.*

Note: Don't treat an antecedent first as singular and then as plural. e.g.

(i) *The Guard Company is now using coal in their furnaces instead of fuel oil.*

(ii) *The club has done their best to raise the money.*

2. Split Constructions: e.g.

(i) *The batsman started to viciously hit the stumps.*

(ii) *If we had the time, we could make some changes, if we wanted to.*

3(a). Bad construction

(i) *This is the book to which I was referring to.*

(ii) *The author gives the best idea of the problem than any other I have read.*

(b). Mixture of figures of speech. e.g. *My castles in air came tumbling down into a bottomless heap.*

4. Aimless shifting from one point of view another will destroy coherence in a sentence. This can be due to a needless shift from (a) active to passive (b) from singular to plural (c) from past tense to present. e.g.

(i) *He ran to the station and the train was taken by him*
(active to passive)

(ii) *If one tries hard, they can accomplish much.* (singular to plural).

(iii) *The only words that we were able to distinguish are 'horse' and 'cart'.*
(past to present).

Practice 4:

The following sentences lack coherence. Try to make them better.

1. *Susan and her sister both saw the film, but she was disappointed.*

2. *I wrote and asked my uncle to let me know about the books as soon as he can.*

3. *He took an oath to never, no matter what happened, reveal the secrets of the organization.*

4. *She is as old if not older than Henry.*

5. *We have and will again talk to him about his plans.*

6. *She, having worked steadily at the sewing machine for three hours and having finished stitching five dresses, she sat down wearily in the armchair.*

III. Emphasis.

(a) **Position:** e.g.

(i) *Her son graduated with honours, we were told.*

(ii) *You shall be called a liar, in all probability.* (weak)

(iii) *She flatly refused to see him, for some unknown reason.*

(b) **Order of Climax:** e.g.

During his long stay with the club he served as president, secretary, treasurer and vice president.

(c) Repetition e.g.

i) The dog was his only friend, his only companion, his only confidant, and his only heir.

e.g.

ii) They believe that most of us believe they are lazy.

e.g.

(i) I have never seen anything like it in my life. (Natural Order)

Practice 5:

The following sentences can be made more emphatic.

1. He testified that he had passed college, middle school, and high school examinations.

2. We were informed by the doctor that the young girl had been told of her mother's death by him.

3. Go away, if you don't like it here.

4. His mother is one person he can confide in.

5. My sister is happy in her new house, on the other hand.

6. It is a worthy cause, I think.

